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[00:00:00] Yeah, right, right. First four years. Okay, good morning, everyone. Good morning. Good morning. Welcome to the September 19, 2023 meeting of the legislative committee.

[00:00:18] Board members should have at your place our agenda and a couple other documents that we're going to walk through today. I wanted to start on your agenda. You can see the list of upcoming meetings just to orient ourselves.

[00:00:35] We have two more meetings of the legislative committee before our draft legislative program will be made available to the public for comment. And then we have our public hearing scheduled on the draft legislative program for Tuesday, November 21st.

[00:00:51] So we don't have a lot of time, and that is all by way of reminding board members that if you have thoughts or ideas for changes or additions to the legislative program, try not to send them to us on Monday, November 20th.

[00:01:08] Try to send them to us as soon as possible so staff can work on them and we can discuss them at our upcoming meetings. And with that, we'll go ahead and jump right into our agenda. And the first item on the agenda will be an update on the recently signed biennium budget.

[00:01:31] And you should have in your packet this handout with some of the highlights. Even in the last week since the budget was signed, staff has been hard at work analyzing it and trying to identify the specific impacts on the county.

[00:01:47] That work will continue, but we have a first cut at it here, and I will ask Ms. Arco to lead us through it. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. So, as you just said, the General Assembly passed this budget after a lengthy delay earlier this month, and then the governor signed it last week.

[00:02:07] So, it's a done deal, and our county staff, our budget staff, and the agency staff will go through it and go in more detail and provide the board more detail as we go along. But we've worked with FCPS and county staff to try to provide kind of a first look at a lot of this.

[00:02:22] And so we'll start with the K-12 funding section and then different staff will kind of work on different sections. We also have DMV staff and a lot of agency staff here that can answer more specific questions as we go along. I will also mention that the budget, this handout focuses mostly on funds coming to the county.

[00:02:41] The agreement did have tax cuts, which in some of the updates that I provided you all by email were included in some of those handouts and in some itemization. And so, but this handout really focuses on funds that are coming to the county and county programs.

[00:02:57] So in terms of the first section K-12 funding, I think as we talk through it, you'll see that a lot of the items that are included in here are a lot of county priorities and a lot of the things that we and you all have advocated for at the General Assembly. which is very nice.

[00:03:13] It really reflects a lot of local government priorities. So in particular, the GA has increased from the work that they've been doing the last couple of years, their work to continue to work to minimize the cap on support positions in K-12.

[00:03:33] So in this budget agreement, they decreased it from 21 to 24 per 1,000 students. So that funds about half of the remaining amount of the support cap. So that's been a priority for localities statewide, certainly including Fairfax County.

[00:03:52] And so that's a really helpful move in the right direction. They also take some of the federal ESSER funds to implement the Virginia Literacy Act. And so that's another step in the right direction. Probably the biggest pot of funding, if you will, that they included in this budget agreement is approximately $418 million in flexible funding that can be used for a variety of things that they outline.

[00:04:21] And so that's money that they really intended to be flexible for school divisions. There's no local match required, which is something that we certainly have talked about, and you all have certainly talked about and advocated for at the General Assembly, that no local match requirement. And so that's something that I think will be really helpful to FCPS going forward.

[00:04:42] And then the next category in particular that we certainly have talked about here a lot is that they did include funding for a 2% salary increase for K-12 employees. As we have discussed quite a lot, salary increases at the state level only pay for the state's share of the salary increase and only for SOQ-recognized positions.

[00:05:06] So in this case, the 2% would be on top of the 5% salary increase that was already included in the underlying budget, and in addition to the 5% that was included the previous year. So in the case of this

2%, the FCPS could receive $5.3 million in state funding, but it would cost them approximately $23.1 million in local funding.

[00:05:30] So obviously, that would put a lot of the funding burden on FCPS to draw down that $5.3 million. Just for comparison, what we've heard from FCPS in terms of the 5% that they already had included, that cost approximately $106.5 million in local funding, and they drew down approximately $29.5 million in state funding.

[00:05:52] So, obviously, we fund the lion's share of it in local funding. And so, that's kind of the general, those are the general items in K-12. I think the last thing that I would mention is we all talked a lot about the JLARC study that was approved by the General Assembly two years ago to study the true cost of public education.

[00:06:14] That report came out over the summer. To probably nobody's surprise, it showed that the state is dramatically underfunding K-12 in a lot of ways and in a lot of categories by approximately $1,900 per student. It made a lot of points that I think we have all been making.

[00:06:33] And so what the General Assembly did is they established a joint subcommittee in this budget to look at those recommendations and decide how to act on them. I think probably a lot of people would like them to take action immediately, but this is the way they chose to do it.

[00:06:51] And so obviously we'll need to be following that closely and working on that as that subcommittee goes forward. And so that's essentially the case for funding section. Why don't we stop there because obviously that's a big one and see if you have any questions from board members. Mr. Chairman.

[00:07:08] Less a question, just more a statement because this has been, you know, education funding has been in our package for as long as I can remember. And this study is important, not just for the $1,900 per pupil, but, you know, one of the key findings in here is that Virginia is way below the 50 state average.

[00:07:29] But what's shocking is we are way below our bordering states, too, including Kentucky and West Virginia. So when we talk about the need to increase funding and education, which lightens the load and the requirements on the county, we're not saying that just because it's a nice thing to do.

[00:07:47] We're saying that because we're literally behind Kentucky and West Virginia. And so, you know, that puts it in real terms for people to understand what it is we're dealing with. And point of fact, we would have a shell of a public school system in Fairfax County if it weren't for the appropriations that came from this board.

[00:08:07] And so while we're all concerned about real estate assessments and car taxes and some of the other things that, you know, affect our homeowners, our public school system would look nothing like it looks like if we relied on state funding. It would be behind West Virginia and behind Kentucky.

[00:08:26] And so it's important that, you know, we stay on top of this issue because now there's an independent JLARC study out that has the metrics. As you said, we are not surprised to hear this, but when we talk about tax relief at the local level, it is impossible to talk about that unless the state gets serious about funding public education.

[00:08:47] And that's just the reality that, you know, that we're dealing with and that a lot of other local governments deal with. And so this has to be front and center in our package, especially now as the General Assembly is debating what to do about it. But this is why for many, many years we've been talking

about this, and now the compounding effect of it puts us behind West Virginia and Kentucky, and to no parents or nobody in Fairfax County would that be acceptable.

[00:09:14] And so I think we just need to underscore this and stay on top of it. A lot of change is coming to the General Assembly. They had a you know quote-unquote enormous surplus this year. I'm glad some of the needle was moved on education But there is a long way to go in this category, and I think this is a moment for us to really reflect on this We supported the study We had an idea of what the study would show But to be frank with you it's far worse than even I thought We would be in terms of position compared to other states around us So I think this is you know, we need to stay on top of this. Yeah, definitely some some wins here

[00:09:51] But it's also worth noting some of it, especially the support cap, was a cut put in place after the Great Recession of 2009, 2010. So a student who was entering kindergarten at that time has lived every school year, maybe they're graduating now this year, with those cuts that are now only partially restored here.

[00:10:18] So clearly a lot of progress to be made. Supervisor Palchuk? Yes, thank you so much. Mr. Chairman, thank you so much to staff for your work on this. I have, I think in addition to what was shared, one particular question because I think knowing that we always need additional state funding, as was shared, one area that's been of great concern to us is the LCI and knowing that we as a county, if you take just our free and reduced meals, student population will be the second largest school system in all of Virginia.

[00:10:47] And so I was excited to see that some of those one-time funds were going to be used per pupil funding which I think I see as an important equity issue to help address specific needs of students and the highest needs students.

[00:11:04] But I know the details are an area that are, you know, the devil's in the details. And so I'm reading here and it says that could receive approximately $28 million and it may be carried into future fiscal years as long as the school division provides their local share of at-risk add-on.

[00:11:23] I don't know if you could share a little bit more on those statements, how much is hopefully certain that will come this year and what we need to think about because it does seem like hopefully this, my hope is that this is an effective way to keep addressing those longer term needs and not just the one-time funding that you can't hire a teacher just for one year.

[00:11:43] We need those staff to be able to be retained over time. So I don't know if you have a little bit more information about the likelihood and anything else we can do to help support and ask for that to be more longer term per pupil funding? - So my understanding about the flexible funding is that the amounts are more or less what they are.

[00:12:02] I think they were trying to provide flexibility, particularly because of how late in the year this budget was passed. This is an unusual time to be passing the budget and everybody's budgets are set more or less. And so I think there was some concern that if they passed it in a date-certain type of way, that some school divisions would say, well, we can't allocate all of this right now.

[00:12:25] And so, because even before the budget was passed, but when they were kind of putting final touches on it, I was sort of hearing a little quietly, like, we hope everybody kind of knows what they would

do if they got money that they weren't expecting. And so I think it was really an effort to provide some flexibility, saying, well, you can carry it forward if you need to.

[00:12:42] So I don't think it's meant to be... I don't think that's meant, I think that's meant to provide flexibility, not a problem. So it's still just one time, but flexible as to when it can be used. Yes, I think it's meant to provide school divisions with the ability to say, well, if we can't allocate it right now because we've already set our staff, we've already hired, we've already made our decisions, well, we can use it next biennium if we need to.

[00:13:06] But I think probably our budget staff is going to need to be working with FCPS, and I know they've already been in touch with them, but to kind of figure out as they make those decisions how some of that works. So that's my understanding so far. Okay, so thank you. So I do agree there are a few good steps forward, but some of this really needs to be more baseline and recurring funding in order to really support the system.

[00:13:28] Thank you. I will also say, I'm sorry, when we get to the program, when we get to the K-12 funding position, we'll talk a little bit more about it's not been updated, But we'll talk a little bit more about why and it's a lot of what Chairman McKay said in terms of the JLARC study because they did talk about cost of living and those types of issues.

[00:13:46] And so we're going to be working closely with FCPS on that. I would also just mention in general, because you mentioned the LCI, this is a re-benchmarking year. And so we will get a new, everybody will get a new LCI this fall. And so obviously we'll be watching for that as well. Okay, why don't we move on to page two in human services.

[00:14:04] Mr. Chairman, members of the board, Ariel McAloon, Human Services Legislative Liaison. I'm going to walk through some of the human services items. The first one, starting on the top of page two, under early childhood, the budget included language that exempts community-based providers that are recipients of VPI grants from teacher licensure requirements, and this change will allow the county's community programs to use VPI funds to pay for teachers so that's a change that was supported in the

[00:14:39] legislative program in the past so that's helpful and also the third bullet under early childhood the budget also provided a 12.5% increase for early intervention services and that was the first rate increase for early intervention in over a decade so that's helpful again but also does not fully cover the costs and there is a need to continue looking at that to ensure that we have more consistent rate increases in the future to keep pace with the current

[00:15:13] costs and then aid to local public libraries the budget includes 3.6 million for additional CD to local public libraries we would anticipate expect the Fairfax County Public Library to get about 36,000 in additional funding based on that change um and um the uh in the state that was also part of the state has made more of a

[00:15:44] commitment to fund public libraries over the next um under adult aging and adults with disabilities i did want to flag that there is 250 000 provided for spark um that um the program that supports essential day programs for adults with disabilities and then moving on to page three the children's CSA the budget eliminated language that had directed

[00:16:21] the implementation of rate setting for private special education day placements that implementation would have led to the state circumventing CSA some sufficiency requirement which was

something the county strongly opposes so that removal of language was good and then under behavioral health the budget did include a number of items under behavioral health the first being that the budget provides 58 million or to expand and modernize the crisis services

[00:16:55] system and so we will be looking at that in more detail because more analysis is needed to see exactly how that will be allocated in terms of how that will be helpful but and it is critical that that allocation be based on population size so that it's most helpful there there are a few items also in children's mental health that was something that the county has included in the legislative program there's 4.2 million provided for child psychiatry and

[00:17:31] children's crisis response services 7.5 billion for DBHDS to partner up and partners to provide technical assistance to school divisions looking to integrate mental health services, and then also $4 million for DBHDS to contract with the Virginia Mental Health Access Program to develop integrated mental health services for children.

[00:18:00] And also then under behavioral health, but moving on to page four, there was some money provided to increase funding for the first three steps of STEP VA, $4.4 million, although that um funding is helpful that the mandates of step ba have been underfunded from the beginning um and that has been a significant problem for localities so this adjustment is a step but it does not address the overall shortfall of funding for the step ba services and then there was also

[00:18:35] 1.4 million in opioid settlement funding included for the purchase and distribution of naloxone and under medicaid also on page four the budget funds 500 additional developmental disabilities waiver slots um the county supports increasing the medicaid waiver slots um which is i'm sorry to address the priority one waiting list which is now over 3500 in virginia and particularly where the waiver assignments to localities are not keeping up with that priority

[00:19:12] waiting list. And I think Daryl may be here if you have questions on that. And I think that that was all under human services. Okay, any questions from board members on human services, Supervisor Gross and then Supervisor Lesk? Age of public libraries, very small amount. We need to say thank you. But My question is, does it come without strings attached?

[00:19:46] I was going to ask if that can be dedicated to purchasing more Paw Patrol books. I learned there's a short, long waiting list for Paw Patrol. I don't know if $36,000 will do it, actually. I need to have more than that.

[00:20:03] Well, my concern is not the amount of money as much as what somebody in Richmond may decide to put on to, maybe not this year, but in future years, some sort of, you can use it for this, but you can't use it for that.

[00:20:21] And we're going to check on what you've got in your collection, et cetera, thinking about what's going on just a little bit north of us. So does this, at least this year, come without strings? I'm almost afraid to bring it up. I don't want to give anybody any ideas. Right. But it is a serious, serious matter across the country.

[00:20:40] And this was one of the ways they could chip away at it. We might have to look into that further. It may have to get us more information. We'll double check. I don't recall seeing anything in the budget language that tied it to anything in particular.

[00:20:57] But we will double check. And when we get to the program, we'll talk a little bit more about it because the state has made a commitment to try to fully fund that library formula. But I think we have some concerns about whether fully funding the formula really funds it to the degree that it should be. But we will double check to make sure that there's no particular strings on that.

[00:21:15] Okay. The formula is one thing. Trying to remove the independence of our library board of trustees and deciding what's going to be there is the overarching. Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Chairman.

[00:21:31] I'm really excited to see the additional funding for foster care and adoption cost of living adjustments. My wife was a foster care and adoption specialist for many years, so I pretty clearly understand the importance of the work that those families do.

[00:21:48] Do we have any sense of how much that might mean to the average family here in Fairfax County as it relates to cost of living adjustment? I think, well, we may have DFS.

[00:22:05] I think Michael Beckett may be here. I don't know if he could speak to that. I think if not, we could probably get the information later. I'm just curious to know kind of what that impact is because I think, obviously, any additional funding is great, but just trying to get a magnitude of what it means.

[00:22:22] It's $2.3 million statewide. Correct. Correct. So probably not a big number. But just curious to see. We can get that for you. Yep, and then secondly, on the behavioral health, I just wanted to acknowledge a few things here.

[00:22:39] I do appreciate the point about the first bullet, the $58 million to expand and modernize the crisis services system, and then the $10 million for establishing additional mobile crisis services in underserved communities and areas.

[00:22:57] I would say, just thinking about my own community, we have some pretty significant needs and we'll be very interested in seeing how this plays out relative to its future allocation. So I just want to express, appreciate this, but looking forward to hearing what the specifics are.

[00:23:16] And then the other point is the $5.1 million to help with law enforcement agencies providing transportation services. I know this was a big issue that came up when we were discussing kind of some of the adverse impacts that police officers face in waiting for these placements to be made.

[00:23:41] I'm excited that there's a method here that might be able to give some relief, but I guess we won't know, I guess we won't know how much would be allocated to Fairfax yet and what type of impact that would have to our police department as a result of it.

[00:24:01] But I guess that's something that's going to come later. Okay, well, I'll look forward to it. And I just want to acknowledge that's a very good point in the budget. So thank you very much, Mr. Chairman. Okay, Supervisor Palchuk, and then we'll move on. Thank you. I'll try to be brief. One quick comment, just want to thank you.

[00:24:16] I want to thank VACO. The Children's Services Act, as you know, CSA is unique to Virginia. I had the opportunity to sit on the state board, and I think this is something I appreciate our CSA staff and VACO continue continuing to follow this. It would have been quite hurtful to have that rate change for a private day.

[00:24:34] And so, unfortunately, we probably need to keep monitoring that, but I think this is a good step forward. On the early childhood, I think some good news, and I wish there were more. And my question

for VPI, do we have a sense, and I see some of our early childhood staff here, do we have a sense of what this could actually mean on the additional VPI funding, or is that still to be looked at for our community providers?

[00:25:00] I think that if the staff who are here might be able to speak to it, but if not, I think that we can get that information. Okay. I know we're probably short on time. So if we could get some more information, you know, as you know, we need quite a bit of additional support and funding. And we know that it's an excellent investment in early childhood. And so any little bit we can get from the state is helpful. So curious to see what that is. And clearly we need to continue to advocate for more support there.

[00:25:29] And then my last one excited to see about spark I believe Janet howell has been quite the proponent of that and I know we're looking to support them Do you know if that's one time or recurring funding that they'll be providing leave the thought would just be one time just one time?

[00:25:45] Okay, okay. That's good to know go ahead Jennifer Vanny, I was just going to say a lot of the funding that has been provided is one time throughout the budget in general there are exceptions but Overall, it's a lot of one-time funding with the surplus dollars.

[00:26:05] Okay, that's good to know. So some good temporary news, but continued investments. Thank you so much. Okay, quick question. Yeah, just a quick question. And Daryl, I'm looking at Daryl. If he doesn't know right off the top of his head, we can get it later. But the 70 additional DD waiver slots that are in here, you know, we have the state priority one waiting list at 3,500.

[00:26:26] I'm just wondering what our county waiting list number is because 70 sounds like a lot of slots until you hear what the waiting list number is. So Daryl and I had this conversation yesterday. Oh, go ahead and come up, Daryl. I'm not taking your place. Daryl and I had this conversation yesterday. I think he told me ours is about 1,000 right now. And so it's part of why we added some language, I think, to that section where we talked a little bit about how the amount of slots that the state is allocating at the moment are not even keeping up with the new additions to our

[00:27:02] list. And so I think when we talk, as we go through the program and as we're working through it, we're trying to think about ways to talk about, particularly the localities where we have growing waiting lists and the allocations from the state are being distributed in a way that isn't keeping up with those lists. And so, yeah, Gerald, go ahead and talk about our list because you know a lot more than I do. Yeah, our priority one wait list is just north of 1100.

[00:27:30] And yeah, the issuance of waivers is not keeping up with the growth. So it's getting larger rather than smaller each year. And so we have one third of Virginia's waiting list, but it says we typically receive 12 to 14 percent of total state allocations. So that formula is not, has no correlation to the size of your waiting list then or how are we I mean it seems like we're falling way further behind if we have one third roughly one third of the waiting list but we're only getting 12 to 14

[00:28:03] percent of the slots in years where there are more slots yes you're correct um it's a problem and it's been an ongoing problem for quite some time so maybe you could explain I mean you kind of explained to me how they're doing the distribution now and it made a lot of sense to me so in terms of each locality and then the region well yeah one of the things they have two different types of waivers, and each locality right now gets at least one.

[00:28:33] So that means right off the bat, you've got 80 waivers that have been assigned out to some localities. And keep in mind, there's a handful of localities where their priority one wait list is 10 people or less. And they're still getting at least two waivers to their individual jurisdiction. And that's what's compounding the issue that's going on, is some of their based policies on how they're going to make sure that every locality gets at least one type of waiver. So this is a problem. I mean, this is something we need to drill down a little bit better because it's like an exciting point here that you feel like, wow, we're getting 70 new

[00:29:11] slots, but we're losing ground. And so I think this is continue to have this conversation, but I think it's important to point that out. Thank you, Darrell. Okay, let's move on to compensation and workforce? All right. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. Florida Survivors. I want to highlight a couple things in the compensation workforce section. First of all, the first bullet says 2% increase for constitutional officers and state-supported local employees. This will likely be an estimated $400,000 over the next six months back towards us. The rest of the increases, which

[00:29:48] for a number of different positions. We weren't able to know how much is coming yet, but we did try to provide at least like how many positions we have or some kind of information on scope since we don't have exact numbers, but that would include, there was money to address the compression adjustment for deputy sheriffs in regional jails, as well as Office of the Public Defender as circuit court clerks and the district court clerks and juvenile domestic relation clerks. So each of those had money towards increasing compensation, but we don't know the local

[00:30:22] effect necessarily on that yet. The next, then there are three bullets at the very bottom of page five, all having to do with incentivizing nurses and getting more nurses into the workforce. So none of that money will necessarily come directly to the county, but it is increasing workforce has been a big priority for us. So I wanted to highlight that. And then on page six at the very top. There are two behavioral health items. One is for the loan repayment,

[00:30:58] so $1.5 million to that, and then $18 million to compensate CSB staff. It's unclear, again, how much will come to Fairfax County, but there is that money in the budget for compensation for CSB staff. Okay, anything, any questions on compensation and workforce? All right, we've made it to the other category. Who's going to lead us? I'll go ahead and do the other category as well. So the first one under other category is public safety. The first bullet I want to highlight

[00:31:33] is has been something in our program for a while. So it's increasing the jail per diem for the locally responsible inmates by $1. Our position has been for two, but we did get one. It's worth note, I mean, it's almost to the point of absurdity here because the cost to house a state-supported and made in Fairfax County is $419 per day.

[00:31:56] And we're talking about going from $4 to $5. So we asked for two and got one. So, okay. Definitely keep pushing on that one. The next one is an additional one-time funding of $2.1 million to the HB 599 funds for local police departments.

[00:32:20] So we'll get approximately $300,000 from that. And this one, I'm sorry to interrupt, but just board members will recall this was one of our budget priorities in our program this year. So happy to see that. Definitely. And then the third bullet is a combination of different violence prevention, safety, community programs for a total of $35 million in investments.

[00:32:46] The next one is the Stormwater Local Assistance Fund. So there's $30 million provided in the budget statewide for that. $10 million is set aside for two different projects, but that does leave the $20 million, which we know is a priority.

[00:33:02] Elections, we're providing $7.3 million coming back to localities to help with reimbursing presidential primaries. $7.1 million may be used to reimburse localities and specifically is in there.

[00:33:18] And then the last thing is an affordable housing. There was a bill that passed this last year that requires the Department of Housing and Community Development to do five-year annual needs assessments and plans and updating them every five years. And so $200,000 was allocated to support that new function in their department.

[00:33:39] Okay. Any questions from board members on other, any of those items? Zarko? So, Mr. Chairman, before we totally leave this, it's not really a budget issue, but it's a state funding issue that was announced last week.

[00:33:54] So Noelle just wanted to share, or I asked Noelle to share something about this. Mr. Chairman, Noelle Dominguez with the Department of Transportation. While not in the budget, we did want to say that Senator Barker let us know last week that he worked with the administration to provide $4 million for the Lee Chapel Road project.

[00:34:13] So we did want to share that. We're checking in with VDOT on how that will work along with the $5 million the board provided in July. Great. I just wanted to say very good news from Senator Barker.

[00:34:29] Okay, anything else on budget issues before we move on to the program? Nothing? Okay, board members have the 2024 draft legislative program at your seat.

[00:34:46] And Ms. Arco is going to walk us through some areas that are work in progress and a couple of changes that we've already incorporated. I wanted to just start, though, on page one, which kind of is the introduction, and remind board members and the public about the organization of the program, which we did change and streamline a little bit last year.

[00:35:13] And you'll see at the bottom of the page there, the four categories. We have our overarching priorities, which are kind of the key perennial challenges, underfunding of core services, education, and others that we discuss, and general lack of local authority.

[00:35:29] So that's always the first section in the program. Next is our initiatives and budget priorities, which we do not yet have. We'll be developing over the course of the fall. And those are specific and targeted legislative and budget priorities.

[00:35:46] that we'll focus on in the upcoming session and work very closely with our delegation to get across the finish line. And we had some successes in that category in the most recent session. And then the bulk of the program are the position statements, which outline the 15-ish pages of positions that we take each year, which we'll be updating.

[00:36:09] And then finally, fact sheets that we produce over the course of the fall and throughout the session to give our delegation specific information and facts that they need. So with that, I'll turn it over to Ms. Arco to walk us through the program.

[00:36:28] And I'll just note, we were successful last year in reducing the length. What I don't want to do is add a page or two to the program every year and wake up 10 years from now and see that it's 30 pages. so

we're going to try to have a one in and one out policy on on words and in positions miss arco thank you mr chairman and we've taken that instruction seriously so we've tried to keep it around the same length as we start off this year so the first position that's in here and the board may recall this from other years we if we have a position that we haven't yet updated at

[00:37:05] the beginning and this often happens in particular with the k-12 funding position because we're working with the school board. We leave it in red, we italicize it, and we mark it as it just hasn't been updated. So this is the position from last year. Because we're working with the school board, sometimes it takes us a little bit of time to, you know, coordinate that first update.

[00:37:24] This year, in particular, because the budget passed so late, and because of the JLARC study that we already talked about, it's just going to take us a little bit of time to kind of think about what we'd like to say in this position. But I think, going back to what Chairman McKay mentioned, I think we really want to think about reworking this position, and that's the conversation we've had with our legislative counterparts at schools, to really focus on that report, because that's the General Assembly's own report that really talks about the shortcomings in state funding and the things that we really need to focus on.

[00:37:55] And it particularly highlights issues like cost of living and things like that, which the LCI doesn't do a good job of capturing. and so we want to try to rework this to focus on some of those issues and really kind of point back to their own study and so hopefully at the next legislative committee meeting which is only in two weeks but we'll have a draft for you all to to start to consider and obviously we'll update it through the process but that's why this position is in red for now and there's a few like this for various reasons and i'll explain why but that's the case with this one any questions on

[00:38:31] that process folks understand the direction that we're heading okay okay so then turning to page 3 Noel will talk about the transportation position mr. chairman on the top of page 3 we had a regional transportation funding position essentially asking the general assembly to make the region whole from the 2018 diversion of funds we have added to that to also request the Commonwealth provide dedicated and sustainable funding for WMATA based on the recent discussions that have happened there and we provide some information on the current shortfall that has been noted of 750 million that that could be updated as discussions continue

[00:39:12] as well as information from the northern virginia transportation commission on what wamada does for the commonwealth's economy and that the the wamada language there at the end of the first paragraph is is what i hope and anticipate will also be the language in vaco's position. So I've been working to get that. Chairman McKay and I have been working to get that adopted at BACO. So it will be consistent. Questions on WMATA, Supervisor Gross?

[00:39:42] I would simply suggest that because the Metropolitan Washington Council of Governments also has a full court press on this, that we share all of this with COG and that whatever legislative program COG may come forward with, and sometimes they do and sometimes they don't, With Congress that this be included, I think it's important that all the partners have the same approach, the same language, the same push.

[00:40:13] Yeah, you know, one difference historically, regionally, is that when there has been a need for dedicated funding for Metro, Maryland gets it from Annapolis. Yes, exactly. And Metro gets it for us. And trying to change that narrative a little bit here rather than begging for the ability to take money out of our own pockets to fund it, that Richmond should look at doing what Maryland has historically done.

[00:40:41] Absolutely, absolutely. My concern is that we don't want to be just doing this independently. We need to make sure that all of our, especially the folks in the WMATA Compact, we all have the same language, and we support one another's approach to getting the funding.

[00:41:02] COG is trying to do a deep, deep, deep dive into WMATA's books, along with a number of other folks. It's not working quite as well as they had hoped, but we need to be united in our efforts.

[00:41:19] Thank you. Thank you. Supervisor Patrick. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. And just adding on to that, and I appreciate the work that you and so many councils are doing on this. I do agree it's very important to include the state needs on this, but also when you're sharing the economic and workforce issues and concerns, I think the more we can do to really tie that in, that it's not just transportation, But it really is an impact to our land use, to our tax base locally and in Virginia.

[00:41:50] But also keep in mind, I think that it does say the currently projected shortfall. I do believe we are awaiting the next WMATA budget later this month that may have some changes to that. And so focused on both the short term as well as the long term needs and how they've, as you know, been there.

[00:42:11] it's not a new thing for a long time now. Thank you. Great. I think we're good on Metro. Mr. Chairman, on regular statewide transportation funding, we don't have any new language. Still references that Northern Virginia should receive its fair share of statewide revenues, that various programs such as maintenance and revenue sharing should be funded, and that they should simplify processes for administering some of the programs they have the statewide level okay move on to governance so mr. chairman moving on to

[00:42:49] page for governance there are only just a few updates at the bottom of page four and then the top of page five you'll see them in yellow they're just some clarifications and small changes not very significant and then as you turn to page five you'll see that the budget priority section is another one that's in red that we haven't updated yet that's basically for the same reason we just discussed in k-12 which is that the budget just passed and so we need a little bit of time to kind of go through it and see what the impacts are before we know what the priorities will be for the next budget as well and so we'll

[00:43:26] hopefully have a draft for you all at the next legislative committee meeting I would also mention that normally at this time of year not normally I'm sure it's true the governor is working with his administration on his budget submission which he will make in December and this will be the one because of our unusual budget system in Virginia this will be the one biennial budget that this governor gets to submit and work with the General Assembly and then implement it's the one it's the one he gets from start to finish and so usually we work on something a letter from the board to reach out to him with budget priorities and so we'll be working on that with you all to try to submit something as we

[00:44:05] also are working on these priorities and so but because of this budget that just was completed we had to kind of see what it was before we turn to the next one which I think is how the legislators are feeling too they haven't they hadn't finished the 2023 session before they could turn to 2024 and so then on the bottom of page six early childhood again those are just really small changes to that section I will note that in a couple of places in those positions you'll see small notes in red italics when some of the BACs have asked us or or ask the board to keep particular positions in the program.

[00:44:44] We try to include little notes in red to you all, just to show that the BACs have requested that that position stay and their support for it. We'll remove those when it comes to the adoption of the

program, but it's really just to show you all that the BACs have said that they support that position as they're your advisors.

[00:45:03] And so this is the first time we're seeing it in the program here, and so that's just a reminder for you all, and you can see there's another note the top of page seven also from the Commission for women and then in the global climate change section there's also a note from the Commission for women other than that there's just a small change in that section Supervisor Paltrey thank you mr. chairman just a question I'm sorry I'm looking through I don't know if it's in here but have we looked at the and I was listening to the

[00:45:40] FOIA Council conversations have we looked at electronic participation and electronic meetings is that in here ensuring that both Commission's we and the public can have greater access to the meeting so in the local authority section we did our language last year about greater participation in electronic meetings did I miss it or is it in there I just have to find which section it is oh yeah so at the top of page 5 oh it's the first bullet at the

[00:46:17] top of page 5 but it's there's a partial bullet at the beginning and it says locality should be granted additional authority to allow for increased opportunities for members of public bodies to participate and attend public meetings remotely while ensuring that public service is available to individuals with a wide array of backgrounds and maintaining the transparency required for the conduct of public business but certainly as we go through the process if there are additional things that you all want to talk about and consider we can but we did add that last year because there was certainly a push particularly by a member of our delegation who sadly will not be in our delegation anymore because of redistricting she'll be in the General Assembly but not in our Fairfax delegation but there has been a lot of

[00:46:55] push on on legislation like that and we had supported the bills but we hadn't put it in the legislative program we try to keep this language relatively broad not knowing exactly what bills will come up or what the particulars of the debate will be in each session. But we did support a number of bills last year that were specific. Right and I appreciate and I guess partly and maybe in our advocacy I do think that specific member had some pushback some of those members will no longer be there but there will be new ones and so if we do need to strengthen it or do anything to this language I think it would be

[00:47:32] beneficial to do that. Thank you. I think we were on page 6? 8? 7? 6? I mean, 7 or 8?

[00:47:50] Yeah, 7. 7? So on page 7, just a very small change, and then a note there, again, from the Commission for Women asking to retain the global climate change position. And then on page 8, just a very small change on CSA, and then again, a note from the Commission for Women. They supported that position and courts just some very small changes there at the bottom of page 8 economic development and diversification that position is in red we have not updated it yet and I will mention that the reason is because when we first started putting

[00:48:26] that position in the legislative program a lot of the position and the edits to the position really did come from out of EDI and were really economic development specific as this position has been in here for a little bit longer the edits have become and the position has become a little bit broader and touched more County agencies and more things that the County does that aren't just economic development and so we've wanted to make sure that other County agencies review those sections that really kind of affects some of their work and so it just has taken a little bit longer to to get that kind of review so at the next meeting we'll have an updated position and I'll just say I

[00:49:03] think this is one where especially as we're looking at other things we really got to prioritize because there's an infinite number of things that we could say there's already a lot and the risk is if we say everything we're saying nothing and no one reads it so as we're working on it let's just try to keep that in mind because there's a lot here already so then at the bottom of page nine under jails there are small updates but I will point out that one of the updates is one that you all already talked about a little bit so the cost of

[00:49:41] housing an inmate is now approximately four hundred and nineteen dollars last year's program the cost was three hundred and something dollars I don't remember the exact amount but it was significantly lower obviously costs only go up and so it has changed significantly and so obviously that's not reflected in the small increase in the jail premium from the state and then under libraries we did talk about this a little bit in the questions about libraries in the budget but the GA did make a funding commitment I think last

[00:50:15] year where they basically agreed to a funding plan to fully fund the current library formula and it's sort of a several year plan until last year they put some more money into it and this in this budget agreement they put additional funding and I think there may be a couple more years in the plan and so that's obviously helpful and we're supportive of that and so we tried to reflect that in the language but I think the question is in addition to Supervisor Gross's question about you know the strings potentially with any funding it's just is that formula adequate to fund really what the libraries need and should be doing and so that's why we tried to reflect that a

[00:50:54] little bit in the language because even when they fully fund it I think potentially that's not what the libraries really would need and so that's what those updates reflect okay I think we can move to page 10 Okay. On page 10, Medicaid waivers, we did try to update some of this language to reflect some of what we were talking about with Daryl.

[00:51:21] We reflected just the change in the waiver rates and the growth in the overall waiver list, I think, based on the discussion that we just had with Daryl. We might want to... Yeah, I think we need to... chairman's point we need to have our number yeah and probably we should because it's constantly changing we should say as of whatever date that number is accurate and the points that daryl made about the growth in the waiting list being faster than the additional slot with the 70 that we're

[00:51:56] looking to get so yeah we can and and as we talk about what we want to focus on in our legislative reception with a delegation this may be you know we focused on behavioral health one year and we focused on support cap and education funding last year maybe we have a ways to go but this might need to be a focus this year because it's pretty eye-opening when you get into the numbers so we'll work on that in between um and then this again has a note this time from the long-term care

[00:52:33] coordinating council asking that you all retain this position so you can see that note at the bottom at the bottom of page 10 water quality funding just a small update there the state has been funding stormwater local assistance fund obviously we would like them to continue to increase funding that's an important fund for us turning to page 11 Jennifer do you want to talk about elections there are a couple updates for the election section the first one is some added language about access for non-physical disabilities, having access

[00:53:11] to curbside voting. You supported some legislation on that last year, and so just wanted to make sure we had gotten that language in there. The law was changed I think two years ago, but the disability

was still defined as a physical disability, so that information is in there. And then the second change is just from purchase to implementation the state did go into contract last year with a provider to update the state system for elections and so we just to keep the

[00:53:44] language current said design and implementation okay following on that page paid family and medical leave there's just some clarifying updates that we've received from staff and then that position also has a note that the Commission for Women and the long-term care coordinating council requested that the board retain this position in the legislative program and then behavioral health oil do you want to talk about those updates yes so on behavioral health we had included some new language noting that the state is working to

[00:54:21] transition to the certified community behavioral health clinics model that's really building on step VA and that's a national model it's designed to ensure access to comprehensive mental health and substance use services so just to keep the language there relevant and current we wanted to include that so that we yes sorry to that a little further down if I could ask I was just having a sidebar with Tom Fleetwood we had a roundtable yesterday with the

[00:54:57] Congressman Connolly on permanent supportive housing and I know we have in here increasing funding for units for individuals am i are we on housing so we're on behavioral health but oh sorry I heard that we do have that in affordable housing both yeah I'm sorry but I was trying to figure out it's kind of linked to both so maybe going linked to this but the housing bullet one two three four five you're now you're talking about page 13 13 The fifth bullet, increase funding.

[00:55:34] Yeah, sorry, page 13. On permanent supportive housing. I am sorry. I misheard what you were saying. I thought we were on the same bullet. I can come back to it over there if now is OK. Why don't you do it now? OK, thank you.

[00:55:50] We're all on the page. My apologies. And so we just had a very robust conversation yesterday about both kind of the one-time funds that are going toward building the units, but the need overall for additional support, as you know, the wraparound services and the operating expenses, the recurring operating expenses are quite large to support the units because they're not just building, but we're really supporting to be successful.

[00:56:18] And so I know the need for, there's quite a bit of local, but for that state and that federal funding, and here at the state level, if we could add units, not just units, but also for wraparound services or operating expenses to that as well.

[00:56:37] And happy, you know, we can work with the housing office on the specific language on that if my colleagues are comfortable. Yeah, I think that makes sense. So it would be like units and something. Because the one-time fundings are a little bit easier to do, and then those operating expenses are the bigger lift that we need more support, I think, at the state level.

[00:56:57] Okay, we'll come up with something on that and bring it back. All right, so let's go back to page 11, right? Or 12, where were we on? Yeah, so the other change in behavioral health on 12 is just a clarifying change in that bullet near the top of page 12.

[00:57:13] And then we also had a note that the Commission for Women recommended retaining that decision. Okay, any other questions on that section? No. So, Mr. Chairman, on long-term care workforce

needs, We got some edits from staff and I think maybe one or two of the BACs that we still need to review because they expanded the position in a way that I think led us to some questions.

[00:57:39] So we'll provide some updates at the next meeting. Substance use disorder. Those are just a couple of small clarifying changes. And then now on to housing.

[00:57:56] So on affordable housing, we added some language to note the need to strengthen tenant protections against evictions. We also included a reference to the surging rental prices based on market conditions.

[00:58:12] And then in the second bullet, we added some languages to clarify that resources are included in plain language just to ease that accessibility.

[00:58:27] And then moving on to human services, in adult protective services, we just had an update to that stat there about the county APS reports of adult abuse, neglect, and exploitation.

[00:58:44] And we did have a note that the Long-Term Care Coordinating Council recommended retaining that position. I also should have mentioned that for affordable housing. And they also made that note for the independence and self-sufficiency position. The second, under human services, that position is otherwise the same as what it was last year.

[00:59:07] And then on TANF, we added some language to note that there's a need for continued TANF funding of programs which meet the needs of low-income families. TANF funding, some of the discretionary funds have been used to fund a variety of programs.

[00:59:26] And there was, there's been some information recently that the current obligations for that funding are actually going to lead to a deficit in TANF. So we included that language to kind of address that issue. And that's something that we'll be looking at.

[00:59:42] It's something that VACO had raised as well. So that's something we'll keep an eye on. Okay. Anything there? All right. Page 14, land use. Oh, Supervisor Gross.

[00:59:59] We could go back to page 12. In the middle of the page in red, the long-term care workforce needs. I have a lot of personal experience with this right now. It says it's updates and reaffirms the position, but it will be updated in a future draft.

[01:00:15] What do you anticipate the updates would be? And I'm wondering, I'm not sure how we define long-term care. I've always thought about it as you're going into a facility and you're not coming home.

[01:00:32] You know, it's going to be for months and months and months rather than, you know, something that's rehab for a shorter period of time. So we definitely need more qualified people. But could you tell me what you're planning to do in updating it?

[01:00:47] So some of the suggestions that we received from staff and perhaps from some of the BICs, too, I don't remember off the top of my head, talked about expanding some of this to additional types of positions like assisted living and things like that.

[01:01:04] And while I understand that concept, I think there wasn't there hadn't yet been a lot of discussion about is there a potential fiscal impact to the county or how does the county use those types of facilities and how does some of that work? And so usually when we have those kinds of things come to us

as legislative staff, we try to make sure that we pull everyone together so that we understand the benefits of, you know, to the people and to the programs on the human services side, for example, in this case.

[01:01:35] But also, is there a fiscal impact? And if there is, that could, you know, it could be that the board chooses to go in that direction, but we need to sort of understand the totality of it. And so the updates and reaffirms the position is the language from last year. We sort of reprinted exactly as it was last year.

[01:01:51] We haven't changed that. And then we just need to sit down with staff and understand what that expansion to additional positions would look like and what would the impacts be before we come back and present it to you all. Thank you, because I think we have to be careful not to throw everything but the kitchen sink, including the kitchen sink, into something like this.

[01:02:09] Right. Because there are very specific pieces. Right. Quite frankly, we have some supposedly skilled nursing facilities in this county that I wouldn't send a dog to. No, really, really. I mean, there are some that are just so awful.

[01:02:27] And many times we get, I don't know about you all, but I get calls from constituents about the care for their loved ones in some of our skilled nursing facilities. So we need to look at the ones that are really doing well and figure out how they're doing it, because they're the ones who are really providing the services, quality services for the clients.

[01:02:52] But there are some that are just not, and probably, well, I won't go any further. But I do think that this needs to have some serious consideration. Our population is not getting younger.

[01:03:10] these facilities, and I can tell you that when somebody is going from the hospital discharged to a skilled nursing facility, there might be a long list of facilities. Many of them have no beds available, and others you just would not even consider. So it's pretty narrow. So this, you know, needs a little bit of extra work, I think. Thank you. So we'll come back at the next meeting.

[01:03:36] some language there for the board to review okay we didn't have any changes to that wireless telecommunication facilities we did have a couple of small updates from staff I don't think oh okay sure we can yeah if the board has questions about those specific updates Jennifer can speak to them but okay no keep going okay and accessibility there's a very small update and then

[01:04:14] again I know the long-term care coordinating council asked that we retain that position in the legislative program and then either Jennifer or Chris can talk about dangerous weapons you can go ahead and take that and the it's really a technical change to how this specific pneumatic gun works so we had explosive instead of pneumatic pressure so it's it's a very technical changed about how the weapons work my understanding of it it's new Matt we you're saying we previously used the word explosive which is not really

[01:04:51] accurate when you're talking pneumatic gun yeah exactly the way it fires so that was a police department this just matches more closely to the definition in the Virginia code okay no questions on that domestic and sexual violence so So turning to page 15, we did not have changes in that section, but the Commission for Women asked that the board retain that position.

[01:05:25] And then the next one that's also in red, so we'll update it for next time, is the safety sensitive positions. The board will recall that we had quite a lot of discussion about this last year, and it was a new

position last year. The General Assembly did pass legislation last year, and it probably wasn't everything THAT WE WOULD HAVE LIKED, BUT IT DID MOVE THE ISSUE FORWARD FOR THE INTERIM PERIOD UNTIL THE STATE DOES IMPLEMENT THE WRAP BACK PROGRAM. THEY ARE STILL ON THE SAME SCHEDULE THAT THEY WERE, WHICH IS IMPLEMENTATION IN 2025. I THINK FROM OUR PERSPECTIVE, CERTAINLY WE CAN STILL RETAIN

[01:06:02] THE LANGUAGE ABOUT TRYING TO ACCELERATE THAT IMPLEMENTATION OF WRAP BACK IN AN ACCELERATED fashion if the state can and so i think probably we could retain that i think we're sort of going around right now with in the interim period you know i don't know if the general assembly is going to do much more if any for that interim period since the interim period is now shorter and so we've been trying to talk to fcps and and police and some of our other agencies to kind of get their feedback on you know their comfort level with where things stand and um and also just a general

[01:06:40] sense of whether the general assembly is likely to really take this up again given that they just passed some legislation and again the interim window has has gotten smaller and so that's why we haven't updated it yet but we were going to try to come with an updated draft next time for you all to discuss okay um and then um next local property tax exemptions no changes there um and and then transportation no Mr. Chairman the change in the transportation section essentially returns last year as the board may remember you had three initiatives stop for pedestrians the

[01:07:19] picking up signs and the reducing the speed limits this puts the speed limit item back in the transportation section of the program but it's essentially the same language as previously The other two did pass, this one did not.

[01:07:37] Am I correct that we have the 25 to 15 mile per hour language, both in the bolded opening paragraph, but also in the first bullet? Exactly. Yes, so the bolded mentions clarifying the language, the counties have the authority, and then the bullet says that as well, yes.

[01:07:58] Okay, I feel like we could maybe streamline that to just say it in one or the other. You know, it continues to be an important issue for us, but a little bit redundant to have it back-to-back there. We can condense. And secondary road devolution, no changes from previous years.

[01:08:14] We just assert that we should not be required to implement a secondary road devolution. Okay. And the final, we have the loud exhaust. And just having talked to several GA members, I think there's going to be another push on that this year, maybe with a slightly different approach, so we'll continue to engage on that issue.

[01:08:43] Okay, that is the end. Are there any questions from board members on the draft program? Again, if you have additional thoughts, especially between now and our October 3rd meeting, get them to us so staff can take a look, but we plan to have an updated draft with some of these areas that are in progress with draft language on October 3rd.

[01:09:11] Ms. Arco, is there anything else? Nothing else, Mr. Chairman. Just the faster anyone can send us things, the better, because it's only two weeks away. All right. And thank you, everyone, for your work, Ms. Arco, and the entire team. And we're adjourned. Thanks, everyone.

[01:20:23] So you can just touch this.

[01:20:25] Morning, everyone.

[01:24:57] Good morning, and welcome to the September 19th meeting of the Board's Economic Initiatives Committee. Interesting agenda, once again, for the committee.

[01:25:14] Before we get started, the meeting summary was circulated in advance. Did anybody have any questions or suggestions for revisions of that summary? If not, let it stand as a summary of our last meeting.

[01:25:33] The agenda today will have a very, really interesting presentation on commercial revitalization murals. Staff's been working for some time on developing the concepts for a murals program for us here in Fairfax County.

[01:25:53] It would be a major piece of our placemaking approach to economic development and revitalization of our older communities especially. We're going to have an Investor Entrepreneur Forms Program proposal, And that's going to be presented virtually by Paula Serral, who is the Associate Vice President of Innovation and Economic Development at George Mason University.

[01:26:20] And it is a follow-up to a board matter that was done very recently, September 12th, asking that this be looked into. And finally, time permitting, and I think it will permit, but we will see.

[01:26:37] Board members have been provided a copy of the Local Economic Initiatives Project Status Report. Very interesting, something we will review quickly and give you an opportunity to ask questions about if we have time. Otherwise, you have the report and you can take a look at it at your leisure.

[01:26:56] So, unless someone has anything, before we get started, I will turn it over to Elizabeth Haag. and for the presentation on the commercial revitalization murals program.

[01:27:13] Thank you so much. My name is Elizabeth Haig, and I am the director of the community revitalization section in the Department of Planning and Development. So good morning, Chairman and members of the board. Today we are presenting a proposed mural program for the county's commercial revitalization districts and areas for your consideration. Now in recent years, community revitalization has been exploring opportunities to use placemaking as a revitalization strategy to foster economic vibrancy in our

[01:27:50] commercial revitalization districts and areas. One facet of placemaking is to build on an area's unique assets and history through public art such as murals. Now the board has previously expressed strong interest in encouraging murals in the community revitalization district scenarios and so we have developed this proposal for your consideration if the board should confirm that this proposal is on target our intention would be to come back to the board to seek funding through the economic opportunity reserve

[01:28:24] fund now as with any new program it is expected that his experience is gained There may be need for refinements. Thus, we are proposing this program as a pilot initiative for the commercial revitalization districts and areas only. However, as experiences gained and lessons learned, we expect to share what we have learned for possible application in other parts of Fairfax County.

[01:28:54] So now I will turn the presentation over to Janae Padmore, who is the Community Revitalization Section's new placemaking planner. Take it away, Janae. Thanks, Liz.

[01:29:09] Good morning, Chairman McKay and members of the board. Our proposed program was developed by researching best practices and utilizing my prior experience working with D.C. Walls. We

had in-depth conversations with Arch Fairfax to learn about their knowledge and practices in recruiting and retaining artists.

[01:29:29] We have interviewed numerous mural artists regarding their experience and preferred public art processes, and to obtain costs and requirements to develop murals. We have researched previously established mural programs and spoken with their coordinators.

[01:29:46] Additionally, we have utilized academic research to develop our approaches. We have also met with each of the supervisors who have a CRD or CRA in their district and have attempted to incorporate their suggested changes to the program.

[01:30:07] Murals as a placemaking tool assist in shaping the physical and social character of an area. For the purposes of this program, a mural is defined as a painting or work executed directly onto an exterior surface as accessible to the public without a commercial message.

[01:30:30] Murals can be part of a larger strategy to revitalize our older commercial districts in areas that can contribute to the economic competitiveness of these areas. Murals can be used to promote resources and advantages of a locality, celebrate unique local aspects of a community, and create excitement and buzz about a place.

[01:30:57] We will be establishing a body to assist in forming recommendations for both the selection of a mural site and the selection of an artist for that site. It will be called the Site and Artist Selection Committee, or SASC.

[01:31:13] The SASC will have seven members. Standing membership will be comprised of three persons: the Painted Fairfax Murals Program Manager, a Representative from Arts Fairfax, and a CRS Section Director.

[01:31:28] There will be four rotating slots that will be specific to each CRD or CRA. This membership will be comprised of the property owner or the representative, a representative from corresponding supervisor's office, the revitalization program manager for that district, and a revitalization partner representative.

[01:31:52] A mural site must first be identified before an artwork can be commissioned. CRS staff will work with community stakeholders to identify potential sites as well as potential aesthetics and themes for these sites.

[01:32:10] Once a site has been chosen, CRS staff will confirm a property owner's willingness to have a mural on that building. Then the SASC for that particular site will be formed. The SASC will have access to the artist database to identify three potential artists that can fulfill the mural criteria.

[01:32:32] The identified artist will be sent a call for submission, request that asks each artist to submit a concept to the committee. The submission must incorporate the artist's required community engagement and public education process.

[01:32:49] The SASC will select the project artist for the designated exterior surface. The artist will create a draft mural concept for review by the SASC. administration will review the proposed mural concept to make a determination that it is not a sign. The design will be finalized and the SASC will make its final recommendation to the director of DPD for approval. The mural then can be funded and installed. Finally, we will celebrate the mural's installation. It is

[01:33:27] essential that murals be seen as a strategy with longevity. All site owners that agree to a mural will be required to allow the mural to remain for a minimum of five years. This will be codified in a written agreement between the muralist in the county. The program will establish policies to address any damage or vandalism to a mural. All murals must display the painted Fairfax logo which is still to be developed. We have researched the cost of various murals of different size sizes and with different materials or techniques. To

[01:34:07] successfully attract artists for a specific site, we'll be paying three artists to submit presentations for the project for a total of $1,500. $500 per artist. The selected artist fee is estimated to range from $6,000 to $35,000 depending on the size and nature of the project. The fee will include materials, travel, work costs, public education, and mural touch-up for up to five years. A key component of our proposed program is that the community be engaged in the process of developing the mural design.

[01:34:47] To maximize our effort, we are budgeting $500 for the development and execution of a robust community engagement process. We are proposing to establish a pilot revitalization murals program with the goal of funding at least two murals per CRD or CRA.

[01:35:13] For cost estimation purposes, we are assuming one small and one large mural per CRD, which breaks down to approximately $8,000 to $37,000, depending based on their size. The total cost for two murals in each CRD, or CRA, is estimated to be $45,000.

[01:35:35] However, because the Richmond Highway CRD is so much larger than the other CRDs, we are proposing more funds for this area, $85,000. The total for the eight CRDs/CRAs is $400,000.

[01:35:51] However, we further assume that we can be successful in obtaining approximately 25 percent of the cost of these murals overall from grant funding. Thus, the estimated total requirement for this pilot program is $300,000.

[01:36:11] And with that, we will take any questions you may have. Thank you very much. That was an excellent presentation. Turn on everything we need to touch on, I think. I guess I would like to ask a question before I turn it over.

[01:36:30] In a lot of towns and communities, I've seen high school students perhaps do a mural. Are we going to have an opportunity through this program to have, whether it's a community group or a high school group or what have you, something other than a paid artist to do murals, is that going to be part of this program?

[01:36:58] something we're encouraged? - So we certainly want to draw from local artists to the extent possible, and so I think we would put that out and see if we could, from the local schools to the local colleges, as part of this program is to create an artist database that can identify potential muralists or art programs that that could produce that so I think when

[01:37:32] we go when we find a site depending on the site and whether that is appropriate we we could absolutely fold that in as part of this program but we we know that some of the muralists as we've shown in in the slides you know do expect to get paid for their work and so we do have the the funding requirement to make this happen okay well I'm gonna just lay out there we're trying to want to determine whether we as board want them to go forward and if so you know if there's

[01:38:11] any tweaks we want to make to their what they've proposed the the next step if it is the opportunity reserve we'll have to go through the whole process again of going aboard matter and coming back to the board with you know more detail and then making a decision so mr. chairman did you have something yeah thank you very much and to answer that question I do support us you know moving forward with the appropriate funding source I do want to follow up on something supervisor Faust said because I'm looking and the pages aren't numbered in my presentation but where we have the choosing sites and artists we have the

[01:38:51] small town big community that was done with looks like some artists and Madison High School students is that our Madison High School or some other school because it piqued my interest simply from the standpoint of there's no cost on it compared to the one on Gaithersburg and Frederick Maryland that are on that same right so that is a Madison High School our Madison High School so so I think just following up on what supervisor Faust said I think we actually literally have to do more outreach to our high school uh school board um partners here because you know

[01:39:30] regardless of the cost i mean there's a cost for schools to do this to materials and other things but in terms of the size of the county and what some of these may cost over time we're going to do this in a bigger way i think it's a multiplier effect and we have some very talented art programs in our high schools I also think it helps the kids feel a little bit more vested in their community rather than you know maybe hiring an artist who might not be in that general area but I'm thinking of our revitalization areas in particular and you know many of them have high schools in them or

[01:40:04] certainly adjacent to them and I think there's more to just the art it's the doing of the art piece that adds value back to our young people in schools and so I think we have to be aggressive in that space my question was we we talked about all the research best practices and all these interviews that we did um i am presuming and putting forward the proposal that you have that that already incorporates everything we heard from them because i didn't really hear anything about challenges that they might have faced and maybe the proposal is written to offset uh some of those

[01:40:41] challenges but i didn't hear any of the challenges or or things that they face that we need to be be aware of going in, per se, unless they're already built into the proposal? We have built that into the proposal. In fact, we talked directly to muralists to understand, you know, what do they like to see in a program, what works from their perspective, and overwhelmingly, we heard that they don't want to create a concept and not get paid for it, thus the upfront $1,500 for three

[01:41:16] artists to create a concept. We've also learned from our local partners about how important it is to make sure that you have the property owner on board and that that's coordinated with the community engagement piece because ultimately you know they they have veto power over what goes up on their building so there has to be a balancing of that and Janetta if you want to add any other ideas. I echo what Liz is saying about artists making artists being able to get paid for their

[01:41:51] concepts they work you know they're on proposals and if they're not chosen that is time lost so they wanted to make sure they went to all of them that we've talked spoken to have really emphasized that that is important and allows them to also put forth their best work and they can put forward enough time to make a really great proposal okay I appreciate that and then and then my last question relates to the property owners themselves because one of the first steps is identifying a site and then signing with the property owner we didn't really talk about all the details

[01:42:29] of what the requirements of the property owner are but and we don't need to I just want to make sure for this to be successful you know we're gonna have to have some flexibility and and that piece of it because we've had some challenges in the past before we had a program in place liability issues legal issues some other things that have come up with some of the property owners and so we want a strong agreement but we don't want to write an agreement that's so strict that we're discouraging property owners from participating and finding that sweet spot you know is going to be important if we're going to have people who are

[01:43:05] coming in and wanting to do this yes and i would say that that's been part of our research we work closely uh did a lot of talking with uh some significant programs in in philadelphia pennsylvania in um in greens greenville south greensville south carolina and and richmond virginia we've We've been working with the county attorney's office on how we will craft that agreement.

[01:43:33] There also needs to be an agreement between the artist and the property owner and the artist and the county. And we have built into this program the idea that the mural should stay up for five years because we're making that investment and murals generally should last longer than that, but we felt that was a good balance talking to these other programs about what's a reasonable expectation of a property owner.

[01:44:02] We also built into the program that the muralist or their agent can come back and do touch-ups should there be just, you know, something deteriorates or, God forbid, some kind of, you know, vandalism or something. So those are other ideas in talking to others and learning from other experiences that we have baked into this program.

[01:44:26] Okay. Thank you. This is really exciting stuff. In Annandale, we actually have two murals that have been done in the private sector without any encouragement.

[01:44:44] One that's going up right now on the side of the Annandale Shopping Center that is Jackie Robinson sliding into a base and Spider-Man climbing over the... But there also is going to be a sign on that one apparently, and so I think we need to be careful about the signage piece because that gets us into some code issues.

[01:45:06] But I wanted to ask a couple of questions. Let me just sort of give them off and then you can answer them. What does large mural and small mural mean? What is that size? Will county facilities be eligible for this? Because in some of our revitalization areas, we have county facilities, which would be great for murals. And this is not to discourage the private sector from doing their own murals. I think we need to make sure that that's very clear. And then could we also talk a little bit about the explanation of what the mural means?

[01:45:44] We have the one picture, of course, in my district of the Mission Lofts parking deck. That's not exactly a mural. It's a way to soften the hard edges. But the really cool thing about it is it's built because Mission Lofts is, you know, focused on the military.

[01:46:05] That paint scheme is what the ships used in World War I to be as camouflage on the open sea. Without somebody telling you that, you just think it's a bunch of, you know, arrangement in black and white.

[01:46:22] So I think there needs to be something added to this program that the county would run about an explanation. You've got down painted, you know, Fairfax, but maybe there's some sort of a little motif

that goes along with it that says, you know, look for these things in this mural or something.

[01:46:42] So would you, size, county facilities, signage. Thank you. So absolutely, county facilities, and as you are well aware, one of the first that we're looking at is the side of the ACCA building as we are about to unveil a new civic space in Annandale.

[01:47:00] So yes, they're absolutely eligible, and I like your idea of the explanation of the mural. I think that's something we can look at. In terms of mixing up with signage, so that is why we, and we've been working closely with zoning administration to make sure, and the county attorney's office to make sure that what we're allowing is not a sign, is not commercial speech.

[01:47:28] And so we're kind of setting up our program that way, and it would be reviewed by that staff to make sure that there is no chance of interpreting it that way. And I'll turn to Janae for the sizes. So I'm going to scroll to this one mural.

[01:47:47] So the bottom mural, what lifts you, that would be determined to be a large mural. And this mural is about, I believe, 20 feet by 20.

[01:48:05] It's about 20 feet by 20. And so that would be considered large. And so we also, after speaking with mural artists, we've determined that they usually are charging about $40 to $60 per square foot.

[01:48:23] So we took that into consideration also with determination of what would be considered large and small. So as long as it's around, you know, $8,000, we're considering that as a small mural.

[01:48:42] Does that answer the question pretty much? Thank you. When we get all these murals up at some point, I think we need to have sort of that walking trail kind of guidebook to these because this could be really really cool yeah we would absolutely get in on arts fairfax uh their existing public art website and as well as probably have our own internal um you know collect all you know 20 or whatever kind of thing yeah uh yes thank you so much mr chairman thank you both uh for being here again today and for our pre-presentation um you know i i share the

[01:49:22] excitement I know there's some of the murals you shared here there in my community I also share some of the concerns and I think I shared those with you before this meeting I don't know that they've been addressed here so I'm gonna bring some of those up again so number one is looking at hearing about students and then I'm thinking even broader about our community as you know we've worked with neighborhood and community services to do quite a few community murals they've been working with community artists both for our public facilities as well as the engagement piece. So, you know, my big concern about this is the order. I think you've got the financing down, the legal

[01:50:01] issues down, kind of the compliance side of it down, but the community piece, number one, seeing that it's the smallest budget for the engagement, number two, the timeline. So, thank you for pulling up the program process. To me, I think that that the engagement piece and the community piece needs to come sooner.

[01:50:24] I think there's an attempt to address that here, but understanding both in the piece and then who's involved in the rotating membership, I would love to see, and I know we've got some NCS folks here as well, that piece needs to be earlier and more involved.

[01:50:44] So whether it's, you know, NCS, you know, Fairfax does a great job at the art piece but the community engagement piece I just don't feel that we have that membership here who really understands

each community so strongly that can both know who are local artists who are students and what where are areas and the equity piece that the community needs to look at and address I think that's the one area where you know the previous slide I think I understand the standing membership knowing this is a pilot but the

[01:51:21] rotating membership you know if we don't know what properties we're doing yet I'm not sure which property owners are involved so I think that engagement piece along with our offices being here but we have true revitalization pieces that I think one of those should maybe or adding one that really is someone who knows the community really well and so I think just the process is the area where as was shared the art is really important but what this brings to the community how this engages and listens to the community is critical I think I

[01:51:57] had shared I love the Arts Fairfax new app or program that's showing where murals are and I started going around my district taking pictures of what would be cool murals and so maybe thinking about ways that the committees can think about how to engage the community and how to get more input and buy-in into this work rather than us just saying feeling like we're dictating this is we're going to put art and this is who's going to do that so I think you know we had that conversation before and I just want to reiterate that here that that's still the piece that I would like to see a little bit more refined before we

[01:52:33] move forward okay if I can respond to that so we did adjust the process and we do now have more upfront working with community partners on both the identification of sites and and themes and what I would say is we never believe one-size-fits-all and we can work with each district each supervisor to involve the community members that you feel are relevant so I think we have kind of a

[01:53:08] box for that I think the specifics we can absolutely you know again it's not a one-size-fits-all what what is it going to be for Merrifield versus somewhere else we'll work with that that area with that supervisor to craft who should be involved in identifying sites in looking at themes in all of those aspects going in up front before we even talk to a property owner or form the SASC and we can also look at again we have flexibility on those positions and who

[01:53:46] who can be on that for each each project okay I appreciate that and then I think that would be very helpful and then the only other reason I bring that up is sometimes the owner is the tenant sometimes they're not and so keeping that in mind I think you may have had some conversations already and then just making sure that you know both thinking about the tenant and the property owner being engaged in that process absolutely thank you thank you mr. chairman I'll just make a couple points one is I'm really excited about this pilot project I think in my district we've already seen similar to the points that were

[01:54:23] raised by supervisor gross that we have two projects where the private sector has made this investment themselves and we've been able to see kind of the transformative impact that it's had. And I just appreciate, and right now I'm looking at the borough and I just, every time I drive along Leesburg Pike and look over it, I'm just in awe of it every single time.

[01:54:48] And I've looked at it so many times. So this is a really good idea. The other thing I wanted to say is I agree also with the point about using student artists. In our district, we are developing the bus rapid transit, and we're also looking at having the windscreens covered.

[01:55:07] And we've gone to the high schools to ask them to give us their best advice and counsel on what we could put on those windscreens. And the artwork that the students have developed has been just phenomenal. And one of the pieces is so phenomenal that we are trying to see if it might be able to be used on our community center at some future point.

[01:55:29] So the idea is we do want to leverage the talent that we have in our community. And could you imagine if a student gets to take that initiative and put that art and that is associated with them for the length of the time that it's displayed?

[01:55:46] I think that's just a great story for them. So the one question I have is looking at the time you have for any, you know, vandalism or repairs that are necessary to the mural, and you've got a minimum of five years, is that a best practice?

[01:56:03] I'm just trying to get a sense of how we arrived at five, and then what happens after the five? Because I'm just thinking out loud here. In our revitalization areas, we don't want things to deteriorate because we're trying to obviously do the opposite.

[01:56:19] And if we get to a place where a mural has been up for, say, seven or 10 years, it starts to maybe fade and it starts to not look so new. So how do we address that? Right. Yeah. So I think once a mural is starting to fade or deteriorate, that would be a great opportunity for another artist to come in and do their work.

[01:56:44] If you look at other mural programs, they have rotating canvases, right? And so it gives other artists an opportunity to display their work and get a moment to shine also.

[01:57:00] So that would be something that, you know, we know that that property owner has allowed us to have a mural up for five years. Okay, now we're at 10 years. It's starting to fade. Let's go up to him and ask him or her and say, hey, can we replace this mural with another one from one of our amazing student artists or a local artist and get that taken care of?

[01:57:24] And what I would say to that, too, is you have to plan, unfortunately, for the worst-case scenario. Yes. If maybe the ownership has changed, whatever, that that is not a possibility to do a new mural.

[01:57:40] I think what we'd be looking at in our agreement between the property and the county would be that if at some point beyond the five-year time frame, because in the five years we have a process for the artist to do touch-ups, beyond that, if the thing starts to look shabby, at the very worst, we are allowed to paint over it, you know, just a solid color.

[01:58:07] And that's unfortunate to lose that, but there's really, you know, and we would certainly try to get it either touched up or get a new one. That would be our first option. The fall safe would be to have it painted over.

[01:58:24] So, Mr. Chairman, just so I'm clear on this, so is that something that we're going to have as a part of the program then? Acknowledging here that this could be a problem. What, if we get the confirmation to proceed in this direction, we're working with the county attorney's office, and our next step would be to create the templates for these agreements.

[01:58:48] There's, you know, we've got to paper this to a certain extent, knowing that we, of course, want to not make it onerous, but we have to protect, you know, the public interest. Yeah, I appreciate that

thought and would fully support that possible amendment.

[01:59:03] So thank you very much. Thank you. Supervisor Harry. Yeah, a couple of things. I want to echo some points real quick. We've got a bunch in Springfield District, too. There's a couple, actually, they're down rolling both sides. Both shopping centers have them.

[01:59:19] So I would want to make sure we're not discouraging private sector from doing these at all. Echo the comments on, you know, students and community members. I mean, I use Eagle Scouts all the time to do things that the government can't do or doesn't have the money to do.

[01:59:36] But I think we need to work that into this pretty clearly. Sonia, but let me go back to the financial 300K. I saw a program manager in there somewhere. Is that a full-time program manager for this? And is that included in the 300K?

[01:59:53] So the mural's program manager is Janae. So we just made that title up for, excuse me, it's on my throat. So, no, it's not a new position.

[02:00:09] So some of her cost is in that $300,000 or no? No, no, no. That is strictly the cost for, go back to the cost slide. So that's strictly the cost of the artists and all that other stuff. It's the artist fee, it's the public engagement. Yes, it's this.

[02:00:24] So the $8,000 to $37,000 is a small and a large, or $45,000 per area, unless you're Richmond Highway, you get a little bit more. So that cost is strictly for the artwork and for the artist to be able to come back and do touch-ups in five years.

[02:00:44] Is there any zoning and permitting costs? No. These will not be considered a sign, so they don't have to get a sign permit. Unless they put a QR code on it, in which case that would be a small fee for a sign permit for the QR code.

[02:01:02] Okay. And obviously, I didn't see, I think if I went back and looked at our website, Criteria Investments will seek a reasonable return on investment. A benchmark evaluation of return on investment over a 10-year period will be used. So that's the EOR process that you're referencing?

[02:01:21] So when, again, if this is confirmed to move forward, we would come back to you with how we aim to meet those requirements. All right. Supervisor Stewart.

[02:01:37] I just want to thank Liz and Janae for this. I think it's a great opportunity to further create placemaking. I think it's an essential part of how we create Fairfax as distinct from a factory area or a data center or whatever.

[02:01:56] I think that's what makes us unique, and I think we need to be, if you will, getting even more all-in on this. I particularly appreciate the recognition that there are different links to these CRDs and CRAs and fund that. And last, but definitely not least, I want to thank Evan Kaufman, who really has led this process.

[02:02:16] I know, particularly for Supervisor Lusk and I, he's really made a difference in trying to create that and got those private sector, and some, I think, public money is part of it, but got that going on the highway, and obviously a lot more to do, but I'm very appreciative of all the work that's gone into this in creating that placemaking.

[02:02:34] Thank you. - Excellent, okay. Basically, I think where we're at is that, it sounds like a lot of support for the concept. We will test the level of that support when we come back with an EOR request, asking for .

[02:02:54] So I will prepare the, I think the first step is to do a board matter, and anybody who's interested, certainly welcome to join that board matter, where we will ask that this be studied by staff even further to address some of the issues, concerns were raised today, brought back, and then ultimately bring it before the board for approval if that's the decision that we make. So thank you. I'm kind of jealous. I think what you're doing would be fun right now. I love these murals, and I see them in a lot of towns when I'm traveling,

[02:03:34] and they really just, they almost make you, you know, they just make you feel better about being. So I think, and so anyway, keep up the good work. Thank you. All right. All right, our next item on the agenda is supporting the entrepreneurial investor ecosystem.

[02:03:57] And I think everyone will recall, since it was just last, very recently, we did a board matter, several of us, asking that this be explored and brought to the board as part of the EOR process if, you know, today we're going to hear the specifics.

[02:04:19] george mason university is very interested in what we're proposing to do and is actually you know we would need someone to do it with and they're stepping up and it's pretty exciting the possibilities so we'll we'll go through the presentation policy role of george mason university who is the associate vice president of innovation and economic development at george

[02:04:48] mason will make the presentation she's virtual at a meeting out of state and then we will decide if we want to go forward with this before i get started uh rebecca maldry the director of our economic initiatives department did you have anything you wanted to add no um but etta and i are both here if there's questions along with paula afterwards okay paula can you hear us i can

[02:05:22] can you hear me? Yes, we can. Thank you for taking the time. We realize you're on an important business trip, but we appreciate you taking the time to present to us today. And I turn the floor over to you. Thank you. And hello from the International Economic Development Council annual meeting. I so appreciate you giving me the opportunity to present remotely. I realize it's not ideal, but we'll try to make this exciting. First of all, I just wanted to thank all of you and to particularly thank Fairfax County. You know, I've been working in economic

[02:06:02] development for a while. I've been working in entrepreneurship way longer than that. And the county has been really not just great partners, but very forward-thinking in what they do in entrepreneurship. And just to give you just a reminder on my background, I'm not an academic at Mason. In my background, I've overseen seed funds, pre-seed funds, convertible debt. Right now, I have responsibility for the CDFI that's at the Community Business Partnership. I've been in national venture capital, international venture capital. So

[02:06:39] the perspective that I'm bringing to this is, you know, what's possible and what I've learned about the ecosystem here in Fairfax County and how to leverage all these terrific assets and I'm not sure if you saw the most recent messaging about Mason the a lot of the university rankings have come out and Mason has jumped in several areas in particular economic mobility has been our biggest leap so we jumped into the top 50 universities in the country so for a 50

[02:07:19] year old institution it's pretty amazing so some background considerations next slide at us the right now there's you know there's there's a lack in early stage capital and I'll tell you how we you know why we say that and how we got to that early stage tech companies solve problems and there are plenty plenty of problems to be solved right now and if those big problems those big and tractable you know national and international impacting problems can be solved here, there's capital to be had. So I mentioned I'm not an academic, I'm a capitalist

[02:07:58] first, but I also believe in capitalism that benefits everyone and all groups. Since I've come into this region, I've heard over and over again what a great venue the grub steak breakfasts were. I never actually attended one, but I have an idea of the model. I've seen it in other venues, and it sounds like it was a great idea. And so it was this group in particular who is interested in bringing it back, and I think that's a terrific idea just based on what I've learned so far. And, you know, the assets and the trajectory that we're on

[02:08:38] here in the region, this is an opportunity certainly for Fairfax, the launch of the Founders Fund and similar funds in the region are a nice plug-in and a nice add. In addition, Mason continues to increase year over year on its research.

[02:08:55] And we're building, we're continuing to grow the culture at Mason so that researchers are more interested in having their research. We can't say commercialized because it sounds bad. To researchers, we say support their research so that it can have societal impact.

[02:09:15] And so we're looking at getting those technologies out the door. And at Mason, I oversee the Office of Tech Transformation, among other things. So by background, there were three research, I'll call them studies, that were conducted.

[02:09:30] One was my own coming into this region and trying to understand it better. That was three years and four months ago. One of the best decisions I ever made was to come to this region. And in trying to understand the lay of the land, I conducted about 100 interviews with stakeholders, with local counties, with some of the cities, with investors, with entrepreneurs, and the nonprofit organizations. And we'll talk about, and the findings were similar to those that Fairfax County conducted its own research, where they were trying to find out how can Fairfax County

[02:10:06] bolster its entrepreneurial ecosystem to drive investment. The questions I was asking was, when I did mine, was what do you think is needed in the region, and what role do you think that Mason should play. And the answer that came back consistently about Mason was that we should be conveners. That you can, you don't have a dog in the fight, you can get investors together and you can help catalyze some of the relationships and develop entrepreneurship

[02:10:40] more consistently. And then Go Virginia Research for Region 7 was actually a project that we one that we had run that I'll tell you about in a second. So the findings for early stage founders was they felt like they needed to increase their visibility. They weren't always aware of the available business development resources. And that really comes from connectivity.

[02:11:09] How connected are all of the assets? There was a lack of early stage non-diluted funding in a region. And, you know, I've heard both sides of the coin. I've heard, you know, there's not a lot of funding and there is plenty of funding to be had, and if you pay attention to national rankings in this particular area, you know that women actually flipped backwards.

[02:11:31] So this past year, nationally, women have accessed less than 3% of all venture capital available, but yet represent 11% of startup companies. They would represent a larger percent of companies if more capital were available, and people as color access less than 1%.

[02:11:51] So it is not an even playing field when it comes to access to that capital. And as far as investors go, they want to see quality deals. I mean, anyone will tell you the term that we use is deal flow.

[02:12:07] They want to see better deal flow. They want to see investment-ready startups. And there's a lot that goes into an investment-ready startup. An investment-ready startup means that you have a great team behind you. that potentially you have some customers, and you're making some, and you have some market traction in order to convince someone to give you funding.

[02:12:29] And this is, you know, this is a long game. We keep hearing anybody who's done this anywhere in the country, and there are lots of best practices, examples of that, is that it takes a long time with consistent funding to be able to make this happen.

[02:12:51] So, next slide, the Regional Entrepreneur Initiative, we convened 40, this was funding through Go Virginia, we convened about 40 organizations who participated, some from D.C. too, and many in the region, and we had three consecutive meetings, we called them unconferences, to identify what the biggest problems were.

[02:13:17] These were the top five problems that were identified. And, you know, numbers one, two, four, and five are the same that you would find anywhere in the country, in any city, and in almost any state, they would say that they have these to some extent.

[02:13:38] Number three is one that's unique to our region. What we're proposing today actually can address each of these problems in some form. Go Virginia is expecting a large grant request from us, from the ecosystem, with Mason as the lead with subcontractors underneath that are addressing with one or two projects that addresses each of these areas, and that's not insignificant.

[02:14:08] They're also requesting one-to-one match to go with that large request, which is probably something we should also discuss. So there's plenty of capital investment opportunity with Missing is a venue, and what we really want to do is for the capital that exists close to home, we want to make sure these investors are shopping close to home, that they're not taking their capital elsewhere because they're finding better deals, they're finding more qualified deals.

[02:14:39] We want to make sure these entrepreneurs are prepared, and it takes a lot to go into preparing a company as i mentioned before you know we they they need to be polished they need to be confident and they need to show that they know they're clear on their business model they're clear on who their customers are and that they can sustain and grow a significant business next slide so the solution you know explored during the interviews and the rei program so this um it's interesting because uh you know you all brought it up in a meeting that you'd like to

[02:15:15] to see grub stakes reinvigorated. This also came up separately during interviews. And when we ran the regional entrepreneurship initiative program for Go Virginia, this also came up that people would like to see this venue for showcasing founders and investors and an exposition of existing programs. Not new to the country, not new to the region, but something that we should, everyone recognizes it's something we should be doing. Next slide. So what this would support

[02:15:48] is relationship development between entrepreneurs, investors, and investors. Often we recommend that entrepreneurs start talking to investors before they're going to ask for money. Develop the relationship, tell them what you're going to do, and then go back and do it and show that you've increased your milestones. It's much easier for someone to invest in someone they know and trust and they're excited about than to start cold.

[02:16:19] Investor education to help identify growth and potential and assess financial risk so that they know the types of businesses that are in the region and they're more comfortable with knowing how those companies grow and expand and connecting the founders with resources to prepare them for funding.

[02:16:40] So the mentors in the region, the customers, the financial resources that are available So all of those things need to be connected. The next slide. So the Accelerate Investor Conference, this was based on an international conference that I used to run with a partner many years ago with a company that's now based in San Francisco.

[02:17:06] And we brought about $1.3 billion in capital to early stage companies that were specifically in the clean tech sector. Then during the Detroit bankruptcy, it's pre, during, and post, we needed to bring capital in to diversify the economy, and we were in pretty dire straits.

[02:17:24] And so we recreated the investor conference, we made it technology agnostic, and we doubled the amount of outside capital that was coming into the region, and we got a lot of companies funded. Those companies today are in the $3 billion mark for follow-on funding that they've accessed, the products that they've launched, and how those companies have grown today.

[02:17:47] So now we're in this region. This region says, well, we need capital, so we set up the Accelerate Investor event. I'll say that, you know, I am so grateful to Fairfax County for being a consistent supporter of this. The Fairfax County EDA has given us funding.

[02:18:05] they've been one of the 28 sponsors. One of the things, by the way, that I've noticed that's very different in this market versus a lot of other markets I've worked in and run similar investor events is that where the large service providers that are interested in this investment space, so those would be lawyers, accountants, consulting firms, who would typically write us a $25,000 check sponsorship check or a $50,000 sponsorship check. I'm not sure why, but the difference in market is those same groups will be in the $3,000 sponsorship realm or $5,000

[02:18:42] sponsorship or zero dollar sponsorship. They'll participate, but not financially sponsoring. I'm not sure the reasons for that. You all may have some thoughts on why that is, but it's a it's a gap and and right now Mason is very much um shouldering a lot of that um a lot of that burden in building that up um but uh we have had success so far so next slide so the results of 2022 i don't know if you recall 2021 was the first year we ran the event it was during covid it was definitely a hail mary pass and trying to determine

[02:19:20] if it was going to work or not um and we had 300 people show up which was great um and we showcased about um i believe the first year we showcased 28 companies this past year in 2022 we had 400 attendees we had 56 investment firms from 10 states attend and these are all relationships that we've leveraged from the past and said come on you have to come and see what kind of tech companies are here place your money in the region and then we were able to showcase 36 companies

[02:19:55] so far those companies have gone on to uh to raise 11.1 million and we haven't even done our annual survey yet that's just the that's just what we know about anecdotally um we'll be doing uh we do a

an annual survey we try to just do it once a year and we'll be doing it in january so we'll have these this data in march for what the total number looks like but already a total of a 500k investment, it's $11.1 million in follow-in funding to these companies.

[02:20:27] So the request was for a quarterly Accelerate Investor event. So I think this is a smart way to go. What it does is it gives the companies more practice and more opportunity to polish. And by comparison, the most recent ecosystem I worked in was in southeast Michigan, in that particular region, not one that you would normally think of as being particularly savvy for a tech economy, but the quality of pitches were good, were actually better than what I'm seeing today in our region.

[02:21:07] Not the quality of technologies. We have just as good technologies as what I've seen in Silicon Valley and in Boston and New York and in the Detroit area, but the investors, the entrepreneurs need a lot more exposure and we could create a more cohesive ecosystem that supports them and that's pretty critical. So the next slide is the budget request. And before we, you know, go into detail of the budget request, I wanted to make a statement here. I don't look at these, the reason I mentioned

[02:21:45] early on is that I'm a capitalist, is I don't look at programs like this as an expense. This is not an expense line item. This is a revenue generating line item. So the return on investment back to the economy is significant. So if you want more funding to spend on great projects like murals and other social aspects that help lift up the rest of our ecosystem like daycare centers and all of the really critical infrastructure and social support, this is a way to make an investment that helps increase the amount of money that's coming in the top end. That these companies become

[02:22:21] more successful there are more tax dollars associated with them and in general it's a better connectivity so the total requests that we're asking so I have done a five-year ask initially there's a reason why is you know we had mentioned long-term sustained funding and how important it is it means a lot being able to hire somebody hire expertise recruit talent into the region and certainly we know that we have that challenge and I have to tell you being at the IEDC right now a lot of people are interested in paying attention what's happening

[02:22:57] in our region. The Amazon HQ2 win is continuing to have a ripple effect and everyone's asking about it and I'm getting lots of hints too about oh well if you ever need any help let me know. So there is a potential of bringing in some really great talent. It's hard to do with you can't do that on a two-year grant. And as you know, our biggest source of state funding is GoVirginia, who wants us to put in a proposal to this effect, and that will get us two years' worth of funding. We still intend to do this. This will provide match funding, or at least over

[02:23:32] the first two years, we could get match funding for GoVirginia. But we should think about this as a more holistic, long-term play. And I just want to give you, as you're looking at these numbers, I know these are not small numbers. These are big numbers in the schema of things. We're also leveraging the costs that are not that that exist that are not in here is we're leveraging much of my staff, my operational staff, the space that we use and Nathan for

[02:24:04] a lot of the events whenever we can. I sat on the finance, local development finance authority board for the city of Ann Arbor for many years, for about eight years. And Ann Arbor's annual investment in their tech ecosystem, that's one city, and it's a city of 150,000 people, their annual investment is $3.5 million a year into their tech ecosystem. And the reason is because it has a return on investment. So just as a comparison. Next slide. Go Virginia. So the

[02:24:42] requirements to submit, I know you are all very familiar with Go Virginia. I have to say that So, you know, Mason has been very successful at getting the Go Virginia funds. We enjoy a good relationship with the funding authority. I've made my belief, very strong belief, very clear with regard to it needs to be more than two years worth of funding because what we're doing is setting up a lot of pilots and we're getting to the point where we're going to experience death by pilot.

[02:25:14] We need to take some of those successful programs, and we need to be able to continue them long-term. For this particular ask, we have to have $1 for $1. They just increased their match requirements. It was 50% for a while.

[02:25:31] Now it's 100. 20% of that has to come from local match, which are the local economic development groups. And we have to have numerous partners that support, and they also want to see corporate support for this admission. So thank you for your time.

[02:25:48] I very much appreciate the opportunity to talk to you today. I wanted to see if you have any questions, thoughts, follow-up. Thank you, Paul. Thank you very much. I would say that what we're talking about at this point is something we've actually had on the table and talked about probably for at least 10 years since we started talking about what's missing here in Fairfax County.

[02:26:20] We have so much going for us, but bringing the investors, the people with the money together, the people with the ideas is a challenge. And this has been brought up. Some version of what has been presented has been brought up a couple of different times over the years.

[02:26:38] And, you know, with George Mason and Paula stepping up, it really creates an opportunity, I believe. But the issue for us is are we as a board prepared to make the investment, which is estimated at $450,000 for the three-year startup period as explained in this document.

[02:27:03] So that's basically what we have in front of us. We've done the board matter. This is the board presentation at committee, and the next step will be if the consensus is to go forward, that we would bring a board, or it would come to us as an action item at a board meeting.

[02:27:24] So that's kind of the, yes, quick update on funding. I mean, you didn't have your mic on. Yeah, go ahead.

[02:27:40] Sorry. I just wanted to know, so in Paula's presentation, she noted that we would be engaging with Prince William County and Arlington County on their interest in participation. So as you discussed today, we wanted to share an update, and we had fantastic conversations with our economic development teams.

[02:28:01] Did not require any convincing. Both of them immediately said, yes, this is something that we know is needed, and we want to participate. So, on Arlington's side, they are committed to supporting a three-year program.

[02:28:19] We're at three years now for our funding request. Their budget cycle is annual, so they are in for a first year, and then we'll make annual budget requests in addition to that. On Prince William's side, they have put in a budget request that will be discussed by their board in December, so we'll have updates there.

[02:28:38] But there's a lot of support and participation, and we think that we'll be partners. And if this is to move forward, we would also probably go out to our larger region and ask for other interest or support

from other jurisdictions as well.

[02:28:57] Excellent. Okay, Mr. Chairman. Yeah, on that point, it's noticeable Loudon's missing from this, and I don't know if there's a reason for that. I guess the other question is how did we determine we didn't talk dollars we talked about their budget cycles But is there going to be a formula or some way to determine what the contributions based on their relative sizes are? Yeah Since we're relatively early in this process meaning this hasn't been approved on our side We actually just started and we worked with GMU on where GMU has a presence Right now, which is our three counties

[02:29:33] Fairfax, Arlington, and Prince William, but I think Loudon would be an obvious partner going forward. And in terms of, yes, we did use a formula. We used kind of a basic breakdown based on population and what GMU's anticipated costs were for the three-year program and then kind of put together a ratio based on population for each jurisdiction. Okay, I appreciate that. I think, you know having some scientific way to determine that is important because as i mentioned you know my support on this is contingent upon this being a regional effort and what we just heard from

[02:30:12] george mason and what you have confirmed in preliminary conversations with arlington and prince william that that seems to be everyone's feeling that this has to be done on a regional standpoint with george mason university and not be a county initiative as was mentioned in here there are a lot of county initiatives already underway and we want to play a meaningful role in this but we don't want to just solely own it and so i think that's going to be that part of it is going to be really important so thank you for the update and progress that's already been made on that if i could add to um you know this this three county relationship is kind of the

[02:30:49] trifecta that overlays with the innovation corridor development that connects the mason three campuses and a strategy that we've been working on to further bolster our three research institutes basically one fifth on each on each campus and the the strategy around creating more of that research making it to the market um i will say that buddy has been supportive of accelerate he's been vocal in the support which is we've appreciated um laden county hasn't financially

[02:31:21] supported yet uh the the annual investor event however okay yeah i uh i mean i i think this we we know that our economy is a regional economy and yeah you can't isolate these types of things from having a benefit uh to everyone in the region certainly it's only fair that everybody be at the table in terms of cost uh but you know one thing that's been missing for a long time in terms of us trying to do things regionally is to have that convener like george mason i mean that is

[02:32:02] we've had updates from george mason on what they're doing from paula we don't have enough time today to go through all the things that george mason is doing to strengthen and improve our local economy and this would be just one part of that uh process so i had uh supervisor lusk Thank you, Mr. Chairman.

[02:32:26] I'll say thank you to Paula for a very informative presentation. I appreciate the points about the development of the ecosystem and making sure that we are providing some infrastructure to support our entrepreneurs in getting access to capital.

[02:32:44] I also appreciate, which is probably not known to everyone here, is that the original program that this is being modeled on was housed in George Mason George Mason operated and managed the program previously and the way that they did it was on a regional basis so the history the precedent here

is that George Mason has previously done this and it makes a lot of sense for them to reactivate something that they've done in the past

[02:33:20] And I'm excited about the opportunity because, as she showed on her Accelerate slide, the amount of investment that has come to the companies that were a part of the Accelerate program shows the value of creating these connections.

[02:33:39] And I just am excited about that. I'm also excited about the point that we have our local economic development entities stepping up and saying they want to participate because it helps their companies. It helps our region. This is like a no-brainer in the sense that you can leverage the investment for something much greater.

[02:34:02] And the opportunity for outside investors to be looking at our community and making decisions to invest their capital here is also really important because what venture capitalists tend to do is they tend to flock around investments that have gotten capital before.

[02:34:25] And the beauty here is if you've got these investors in all these different places, that means we have the opportunity to get even more investment coming into our region. And that's been something that we have seen happening more and more, but I will be clear in saying that in the early stages, that has not always been the case.

[02:34:45] So I'm excited, and Paul, I might just ask one question of you, if I could. Under the budget request, you talk about the company pitch coaching and the ongoing advising and support. Could you talk a little bit about that in terms of how we're going to help the companies get prepared for their presentations, and then how are we going to help them as they're thinking about maybe growing their businesses?

[02:35:14] Are there other services that we can provide in supporting them as well? So that's a great question. With regard to mentorship and support, we leverage the Mindshare Network.

[02:35:30] They have been great in helping to, in donating their time to be able to help review pitches. They've been fantastic. But besides the volunteer network, it's really critical to have a full-time paid group of people who also have experience in entrepreneurship and can provide coaching.

[02:35:49] That was why we created the ICAP program. So the ICAP program had been at Mason about a year before I got there. And, you know, it's a lean startup program, so it puts early stage companies through a process.

[02:36:05] What we added to it was a mentorship program layered on top, And that was to catch up, really, Virginia with 20 other states that had tech mentors that sit on top of their Small Business Development Center program.

[02:36:23] So one of the things we do for the Accelerate Investor event now is we make it mandatory that these companies get help. They use a software system so that there's ongoing follow-up. We make sure that we track companies and what happened to them, and we follow them throughout their lifetime.

[02:36:42] We have mentors with different areas of expertise, and we engage, depending on what the company needs at the time, whether it's industry-specific or if they need a finance expert versus a marketing expert, we make sure that they are attached to the mentor that can provide them that support at the time they need it.

[02:37:05] So with regard to the companies and matchings, The intent is to involve companies and government as well, especially federal government, in these events. The reason why is because companies become more attractive to venture capital when they've obtained customers.

[02:37:27] And one of the missing things in the ecosystem, I'm working on it, but I need a little more time to develop it, is the first customer program to help get companies that first customer. It helps them, one, is it reduces their need for government funding and helps them become more sustainable and reliable.

[02:37:46] But two, is it makes them more attractive to investors as well. Now, I'll say thank you very much for that clarification and that first customer model. I really like that. I had not heard that before, so I'll be interested in learning more about it.

[02:38:02] So thank you very much. Thank you. Supervisor Smith. Thank you. I guess I want to understand the cost and the budget a little bit better. talking about 450 dollars for three years now you're talking about other localities coming in so are you looking at this is still us and the other localities are providing more revenue or they're taking a piece of this to be involved in it um i'll start rebecca do you want to yeah sure um so the 450 is our portion um and uh the board matter was written and we're continuing operating

[02:38:39] I would say up to $450,000 for this three-year period. And so we do have, and we could share after this meeting, a little bit more detail on the budget and what that includes. Some of the broad topics were listed, but we do have line item budgets under that.

[02:38:59] So the up to $450,000 is our portion. I think the benefit of EOR is that it is kind of the funds are spent as needed. So those would be allocated to GMU on an annual basis.

[02:39:16] So, for example, if we were to receive additional funding from other jurisdictions, then our portion could potentially go down. And so that's why I'm kind of continuing to say up to $450,000, that's our amount if no other jurisdictions come in.

[02:39:33] But that does kind of include Arlington and Prince William coming in. So I don't anticipate that our portion would go down significantly, even with Prince William and Arlington. Does that answer your question?

[02:39:49] Yeah, I think that would be helpful to understand where you see the costs. You know, and it's always a question about, are we creating redundancies? What work is already being done? And is it redundant what we're doing? So that's something I want to hear about. And then sometimes when you do these requests, it's the biggest, best-case scenario.

[02:40:09] So we're talking about doing it three more times. Well, there's no thought of, well, what if we did it once more with the Accelerate conference that GMU has, or we do it twice more? Just to have some options to consider. You know, I said at the board meeting the other day, I'm just, I hear that this is investment, but I need to see that and understand it because I think we're at a time with our budgeting that we need to be a little careful.

[02:40:33] Thank you. Okay. Thanks. Thank you, Supervisor Smith. Supervisor Herod. Yeah, real quick. First, Paula, thank you for outstanding conversation, I mean, presentation. This thing is way overdue, and I hope we do move forward with it.

[02:40:52] I'm not ready to limit it on other jurisdictions participational and understand the desire and want to, and I think we should do everything we can. Chairman mentioned Loudoun, Alexandria is kind of missing from this too, and I understand why those three jurisdictions were there, but I think we try to broaden it to include Loudoun, Alexandria.

[02:41:14] You know, on the Y three times, making total of four times per year, I think the goal here really is to get private sector investors here. I mean, and you need this stage to get, you know, the venture capital stage and the early stage investors here.

[02:41:31] So the more deals you get, the better. So I think, you know, at least quarterly is the right answer, clearly. And I'll take a stab at answering your question, Paula, is why investments seem lower here than elsewhere. And we've always thought, you know, in the financial community, it's because most of the money that's made here is made here in a very risk-adverse industry, which is government contracting.

[02:41:58] So they tend to be more risk-adverse. So some of this needs to be investor education as well as just prepping the presenters. It's also prepping some of these people who have made multi-millions of dollars in an industry that's not really risk-taking to a large degree, as early-stage investing is.

[02:42:21] But the rewards are a lot better, obviously, in early-stage investing. So that's all my comments, but I hope this gets moved forward. Thank you. Supervisor Sturck. Thank you, Mr. Chairman. And obviously, this is, I think, a wonderful approach to increasing what I would call the frequency of opportunity.

[02:42:41] And the frequency of opportunity, I think, is directly correlated only to success. I don't think it has to necessarily be as quality. I think it needs to just happen. And organically, I think things then ultimately work out, and there's kind of an opportunity that emerges if it's truly going to be a successful opportunity.

[02:43:01] So I think we clearly need something like this. We clearly need to be creating a place that people want to come. I know that we want that to be successful, but I think initially we just want people to come and try to see if we can build off of that and kind of stair-step our way into, if you will, the major leagues.

[02:43:23] I mean, we know we're a significant player nationally, but we know we're not in the major leagues, at least that's the surveys and stuff that we've looked at. We still have our ways to go to get there. So I'm all in on the frequency part of this. I think that will help not only the potential investors, but especially, absolutely especially the entrepreneurs.

[02:43:40] You know, you pitch once and you realize, well, you know, I heard somebody else and they did this or that, and I need to think about this or that, or they're asked tough questions, and that gives them an opportunity to not have to wait years for maybe another opportunity, but hopefully a quarter or two.

[02:43:57] I'm not 100% clear on the big government impact. I recognize kind of what that means, but I guess I wanted to make sure that I got an explanation as to what or how you all see that. The slides aren't numbered. It's the one about regional entrepreneur initiative.

[02:44:15] And number three is develop a successful entrepreneurial ecosystem not crowded out by big government. And, again, I sort of gently know what it means, but is there a particular intentionality with that statement? Paula, do you want to take that question?

[02:44:32] Yeah, so this was an outcome of the 40 organizations that I mentioned in the region that people who are particularly interested in entrepreneurship and entrepreneurial development.

[02:44:50] One of the most obvious elements is talent. And so while big government, especially big government contractors, pay a lot for talent when you're trying to convince someone to. So it's talent-related.

[02:45:08] To be an entrepreneur, it's quite high to go. Yeah. Although we lost you for a minute. My information is anecdotal, but can you hear me? Yes, go ahead. Okay.

[02:45:25] So I don't know if you heard that part. It was about talent, and big government can take a lot of the talent resources out of the space. There's also, you know, this is something that I saw firsthand as well when I was dealing with Big Auto,

[02:45:45] A company can go, can work for a big government contractor and make a large salary, or, you know, they can take a big risk and do an entrepreneurial startup, and, you know, big government contractors have a lot of the, they take a lot of the prime real estate, they take a lot of the wind out of the sails, and because the region, and this is, this comes back to the economy report that was done, I think it was 2017,

[02:46:16] 2018, somewhere in there. Because that is such a huge part of the industry, it has made a less diversified economy, which has impeded innovation in the region. That's helpful. I want to better understand that. Thank you. And last point is just, I know we need to do this first, and I know that this is our focus for lots of reasons as a county, but it is tech-focused. I think there are plenty more entrepreneurial opportunities beyond just tech in the healthcare sector, and I realize

[02:46:54] those aren't specific strengths of Fairfax County at this point in time. I think that changes over time. So I'm all in on focusing here now, but I think we've got to look at other ways to encourage and support and develop these other kinds of talents that go beyond tech, healthcare, and obviously social services and other opportunities for growing those creative minds and creative businesses that I think will be the future.

[02:47:23] Thank you. I agree. Yeah, I agree with you. And because my team is also, the Small Business Development Center is part of my team as well. We look at, we work with non-tech companies. The majority of the 10,000 businesses that we support in Virginia each year are non-tech.

[02:47:41] About 1,500 are tech-related. So of those non-tech companies, I would love to work with Fairfax County on other ways that we can encourage the types of businesses that are needed right now in the region. Consider me one of those individuals is happy to work with you because I believe, and particularly for the southern part of the county, I think it's a more essential element of our success long term.

[02:48:04] Thank you. Thank you. Well, I think what we need to do is have your team, Rebecca, address some of the issues that have been raised and answer some of the questions.

[02:48:22] I mean, they're not really issues, but, you know, what will the regional participation be, for example? And I think the redundancy issue and just, you know, demonstrate that this is money well spent, I guess, is the bottom line.

[02:48:44] And, you know, I think the next step in the EOR process is to bring it before the board as an action item. So, you know, we will do that when you tell me you've reached out and, you know, provide the

information that the board members are looking for and that there's a consensus that they're satisfied with the response.

[02:49:08] Once we get that, I think we're ready to do the board or the action item. And, of course, we meet the answer yesterday. Paula, thank you so much.

[02:49:27] You know, all of these programs are great individually, but the whole is greater than the sum of the parts. And I think George Mason's done an amazing job of bringing these things together and just building on one success after another, one good program after another.

[02:49:47] So thank you, and we look forward to continuing the wonderful relationship between the county and your group. Thank you. Thank you so much. Anything else? There is another presentation, but I'm not going to squeeze it in in two minutes because it's just an update on where we're at on about five or six different economic development programs.

[02:50:13] Rebecca, was there anything specific you wanted to highlight without going through the whole presentation? Are you sure? It's lunchtime. Are you sure you guys don't want to stay just a little bit longer? No, absolutely. There is maybe just two quick points, maybe three, but I'll be very brief.

[02:50:33] First, this is a presentation only of our major initiatives that are currently launched or have kind of a significant update. We included in there some of the important points about the impacts that we're seeking, namely growing jobs, growing businesses, supporting economic mobility, and supporting businesses to increase and maintain their sales so that they can increase or maintain their commercial presence.

[02:51:00] But I would like to jump really quick to the Thrive program. We're very excited. This is the Thrive Small Business Technical Assistance Grant Program. We have been working extremely hard.

[02:51:15] This is a complex initiative with many, many partners. We were excited to receive more than 300 submissions from businesses to provide the technical assistance to the upcoming applicants.

[02:51:31] So we are reviewing those RFPs now. And those are RFPs in many categories across business operations, marketing, finance. The next phase, this is a new approach that we're taking to really double down on our efforts to reach diverse business owners in Fairfax County.

[02:51:52] We have an RFP open to bring together partners that have experience and qualifications and are very connected to local communities so that they can help us reach small and diverse businesses and let them know about the Thrive Program.

[02:52:11] So that RFP is open now. Again, that's for organizations that work with small and diverse businesses. And there's more information, of course, on our website. and in the RFP, and that is due October 2nd, I believe.

[02:52:27] So more information is on our site. And if any of you have any other questions about the additional programs that are listed here, then, of course, we would be happy to answer questions at any time. Did anyone have anything today they wanted to ask?

[02:52:46] Anybody do their homework and come in here with a question about that? Okay, very good. Did you have a question? I was just going online to look. Just a one-page, maybe two-sided at most, summary of all that we do to support small business entrepreneurism.

[02:53:06] I mean, even what the program we just were talking about. I know we do the Entrepreneurship 101, EDA does that, et cetera. But just something that I can wrap my head around it or hand to a small business, hey, here's a list of opportunities and happy to work with you on these kind of quick and dirty or even obviously a link that you could click them.

[02:53:26] I know there's some things on you, and I was just looking to see what it is, but I just want to make sure if that's not available, if you all could look at putting it. We would be happy to do that, and I can't miss the chance with that transition to put in a plug for the initiative we're working on, Fairfax Core, which is listed here as well, connecting opportunities and resources for entrepreneurs, which is really the massive effort to bring together our dozens and dozens, almost hundreds of partners that work in the entrepreneurship support and small business support space.

[02:54:00] We are now working with over 70 of our resource partners to kind of populate a resource navigator with the goal that pretty soon it will be one place that entrepreneurs could go to find more customized and direct connection to connect with the resources they need when they need it.

[02:54:20] So that will be launching in the spring. Much more information to come. But in the meantime, happy to put that together for you. - Thank you, and I just can't emphasize enough the difficulty, the degree of difficulty of an entrepreneur trying to do be all things to all people and having it simple and easy to follow on a roadmap of sorts, will make all the difference in the world to some of their successes or failures.

[02:54:47] Thank you. Very quickly, first of all, I am just thrilled to see all of this. I know coming into the seat, I was a little jealous of things I was seeing at Arlington. No longer. They should be jealous of us. I think these are just excellent programs. A quick question, and I know Rebecca and I talked briefly about this.

[02:55:04] Last night we had a wonderful SSPA meeting with the Merrifield area, And we did hear from a couple of local businesses questions about space, about class B and C, and also industrial and the smaller scale industrial. So I don't know if that's something you are already looking into.

[02:55:22] I don't want to add more to your plate, but I think as we go through some of these SSPA and other redevelopment processes, understanding the needs or the gaps and the impact on our small businesses for areas around space and having that ability to space.

[02:55:39] That's an ongoing discussion. Another topic that we included in here is something that I'm calling an economic roadmap, which is looking at, I would say, a comprehensive consideration of not only office space, but also emerging opportunities of that space and needs kind of across the spectrum of different commercial and business owners.

[02:56:07] So I would say my office, but particularly along with the EDA, but we work often with small businesses that are looking for unique space. So if you ever receive those requests, we'd be happy to engage as possible.

[02:56:23] So I'd love to talk with you about that further. Okay, absolutely. And I think if we start to see greater trends that we need to address more on our, whether it's development or licensing or other issues that you're seeing, I think that would be helpful. we'll send them all your way and then as you see trends or anything we need to address i know you'll share them with us okay very good thank you if there's nothing else to come for the committee the meeting is adjourned thank you



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